

ARDMORE PARISH NEWSLETTER

Twenty-Sixth Sunday in Ordinary Time — Year A

Sunday, 27th September 2026

† Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 21:28–32 — *Faith Shown in Action*

Life is full of promises — to change, improve, forgive, serve, and do what is right. Yet even sincere intentions can sometimes remain only words.

In today's Gospel, Jesus tells of two sons who were asked to work in their father's vineyard. One refused but later changed his mind and went. The other agreed to go but did not.

The message is simple and challenging: **our actions matter more than our words.**

True change turns faith into action. Today's Gospel invites us to be honest about where we need to grow; to live out kindness and forgiveness; to refuse to be defined by past mistakes; to offer God a willing heart; to examine our conduct; and to embrace every opportunity to do good.

God values sincere action over empty promises — and **it is never too late to begin again.**

Lord, fill our hearts with Your love and guide us to live our faith each day. Amen.

Annual Safeguarding Mass

Bishop Router invites everyone involved in safeguarding to the **Annual Safeguarding Mass** on:

Friday 2nd October at 7.30 pm
St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry

The Mass will be offered for **peace, reconciliation and healing for all who have suffered the pain of abuse.**

It will also be offered in thanksgiving for Parish Safeguarding Representatives throughout the diocese, together with diocesan staff and volunteers who continue to support and develop safeguarding practices across our Diocese.

Open Heart — Open to the Word

Thornhill Ministries will lead an introduction to the practice of praying Scripture in a reflective way, helping participants to let the Word of God nestle in the quiet corner of the heart.

Four Sundays in October

3.30 pm – 4.30 pm

Emmaus Room, Pennyburn Church, Derry

All are welcome.

Monthly Men's Rosary

The **Monthly Men's Rosary** will take place on:

Saturday 3rd October at 1.00 pm

Market Square, Letterkenny

New attendees are very welcome.

St Faustina Weekend — Divine Mercy

A **St Faustina Weekend** takes place in:

St Mary's, Convoy, F93 FX66

Saturday 3rd & Sunday 4th October

The weekend will include prayer and reflection on the **Divine Mercy Devotions** and will be led by **Fr Eamonn Kelly**.

The weekend invites us to come to know the Person of Divine Mercy.

You are welcome to attend **all or part of the weekend**.

ACCORD Marriage Preparation Course

The next **ACCORD Marriage Preparation Course** takes place on:

20th & 21st November

Ebrington Hotel, Derry

Places are limited.

Booking: www.accordni.com

ACCORD Derry Couples Counselling

ACCORD counselling specialists provide both **in-person and online services** to individuals and couples experiencing relationship challenges.

Telephone: (028) 7136 2475

Email: derry@accordni.com

Website: www.accordni.com



Triduum of Masses — St Therese of Lisieux

The **Annual Triduum of Masses for the Feast of St Therese of Lisieux** takes place at **Termonbacca, Derry**, from:

Tuesday 29th September – Thursday 1st October

7.30 pm each evening

Tuesday: Healing prayers for all those who are sick

Wednesday: Special blessing of children

Thursday: Blessing of roses

Everyone is welcome to come along and join in the celebrations.



Serving as a Priest

Are you **18 or over** and thinking or wondering about serving the Church as a priest of the Diocese of Derry?

An afternoon gathering will take place in **Derry on Sunday 11th October**, with time for:

Prayer • Discussion • Questions & Answers

For further details, please contact:

Fr Pat O'Hagan

pgoh2111@gmail.com



Novena to Our Lady, Untier of Knots

The **Novena to Our Lady, Untier of Knots** begins after the **7.30 pm Mass on Thursday 1st October in St Eugene's Cathedral** and continues each Thursday until **26th November**.

Do you have “knots” in your life?

Knots of discord in your family, unresolved pain in relationships, or a lack of peace and joy in your home? Sometimes life can feel like one overwhelming knot, especially when we face health challenges or burdens beyond our control.

This novena reminds us that sin never entangled Our Lady and that Christ gave us His Mother as **Our Lady, Untier of Knots**.

Through this devotion, we entrust our personal “knots” to her loving care — learning to let go and allowing her to gently untie what binds us.

All are welcome to join in prayer and reflection during this special time of grace.

Catholic Mothers Ireland — Ulster Retreat Day

Saturday 3rd October

10.00 am – 6.00 pm

Benburb Priory

A day of **prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal**.

Speakers:

Fr Barry Matthews • Fr Gerry Campbell • Helen Stewart • Jim Deeds

Lunch and refreshments are provided.

Cost: £45

Booking: www.catholicmothers.ie/retreats

Season of Creation

A River of Hope

Every community, prayer and action for our common home is **a drop of hope**.

From Italy to Chile, Bogota, Glasgow, Bengaluru and Winnipeg, Living Water is flowing — through celebrations, learning experiences with young people, daily commitments and concrete actions to care for creation.

Together, these individual drops become a river of hope and remind us that even small actions can contribute to the care of our common home.

More information:

laudatosimovement.org

Safeguarding

If you have any concerns regarding the safeguarding of **Children, an Adult at risk of harm, or an Adult in need of protection within the Church**, please contact:

Marie Gormley

Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP)

Tel: 07596 500793

Email: marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland

To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities:

PSNI: 101

Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services: 028 71 314090

WHST Adult Gateway Services: 028 71 611366

Regional Emergency Social Work Service: 028 9504 9999

Republic of Ireland

To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities:

Garda Síochána, Buncrana: 074 9320540

Garda Síochána, Letterkenny: 074 9167100

TUSLA Child and Family Agency: 074 9102233

HSC Adult Safeguarding Donegal: 071 9834660

"It is never too late to begin again."

May the week ahead be filled with faith expressed in action, kindness offered freely, and the courage to answer God's call in the ordinary moments of everyday life.